The Payson Morning Scroll

Made Exclusively for the Mogollon's Hearth Guests

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

The Greybeards of High Hrothgar — Publisher & Proprietor

Payson, Arizona · Middas, the 14th of Frostfall (Wednesday, October 14, 2026) ·
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Gandy basks half-asleep in the sun while Maevy chases a butterfly clean off the deck.

Skies o'er the Hold

60° / 44°

Sunny and clear

Sunrise 6:30 AM · Sunset 5:51 PM

Tomorrow — Sunny, 67/52

The Moon's Reckoning



Yesterday *Tonight* *Tomorrow*

Waxing Crescent

waxing toward the full moon

14th of Frostfall = October 14

Months run one-for-one all year

Sundas=Sun … Loredas=Sat

Around the Holds · The Week Ahead

Sun Returns to the Holds, and Every Hall Fills With Song

Payson, Ariz.



A sunny Middas in the Hold: stories for the little ones, bards tuning up, and the Rim shining clear after the rain.

Good morrow, friend of the Hearth, and throw open the shutters — Middas dawns bright and clear over the Payson Hold, sunny all day to 60 degrees after yesterday's rain. The library welcomes its smallest travelers for songs and board books this morning, estate buyers open their strongboxes in Sedona, and Prescott sings late with an open mic and a country band. Ahead come folk harmonies in Payson on Thursday, painters spreading across Sedona on Friday, and a bazaar and a Cowboy Prom in the Show Low country on Saturday. By the Nine, it is a fine week to be on the road — come along.

Happening in the Holds Today

- **Payson**

  — Baby Story Time at the Payson Public Library — 10:30 AM, 328 N McLane Rd. The library celebrates its youngest readers with board books and songs, in a gentle gathering made for babies and their grown-ups. It is a sweet first mead-hall for the Hold's smallest travelers, and a fine way to meet other young families. No registration is needed — just come and sing along.

  — Tai-Chi at the Payson Public Library — 9 AM, 328 N McLane Rd. Start the sunny Middas with slow, deliberate movement among friends at the library's regular Wednesday Tai-Chi gathering. The practice is gentle, welcoming to newcomers, and made for cultivating balance and connection. A calm way to greet a clear day before the town fully wakes.

- **Sedona**

  — Renee Taylor Jewelry Buying Event — 9 AM–6:30 PM, 313 AZ-179, Suite B14, Sedona (final full day; Thursday runs to 5:30 PM). Estate Buying Specialists will examine your gold, coins, fine jewelry, diamonds, sterling silver, watches, and other rarities, and give an honest evaluation on the spot. Sell, and payment is immediate — no appointment needed, just walk in. A fine chance to turn a drawer of old treasures into septims for the road.

- **Prescott**

  — UAF Fundraiser at LazyG Brewhouse — from 11 AM, 220 W Leroux St, Prescott. Grab a bite at LazyG and a portion of the proceeds benefits United Animal Friends, with raffle tickets and handmade doggie scarves on offer besides. Best of all, adoptable dogs will be there to meet — come for lunch and you may leave with a new quest companion. Good food, good cause, good dogs.

  — Hashknife Express LIVE at Whiskey River Tavern — 6–9:30 PM, 214 S Montezuma St, Prescott. Hold onto your hats — Hashknife Express gallops in with its signature Arizona-grit, feel-good country-rock sound. An early-evening set on Whiskey Row, made for travelers who like their music with dust on its boots. Come hungry for a tune and stay for the choruses.

  — Musicians with Heart Open Mic — 7–10 PM, Jersey Lilly Saloon, Prescott. Local voices take the mic all evening, and every donation goes to local charities. It is the kind of night where a stranger's song can steal the whole room, and the giving does as much good as the listening. Singers, players, and the merely merry are all welcome.

The Days Ahead

- **Thu, Oct. 15**

  — **A Band Called Honalee** — 7 PM, 301 S McLane Rd, Payson. This modern-day folk trio relives the timeless magic of Peter, Paul & Mary, bringing classics the whole hall knows by heart to life with stirring vocal harmonies. The show also honors Dylan, Joni Mitchell, and other legends of the age. A warm Turdas evening of songs carried the way traveling bards once carried news between holds.

  — **Gary Allan** — 7:30 PM, Findlay Toyota Center, Prescott Valley. The country powerhouse brings his signature grit and soul to the stage, with special guest Julie Eddy. Nearly three decades of hits delivered with a raspy, rebellious edge that fills a big hall. A big-night outing for Valley Dwellers and Hold folk alike.

- **Fri, Oct. 16**

  — **3rd Friday Art Walk, Camp Verde** — 4–6 PM, Town of Camp Verde, 646 S 1st Street. Camp Verde's galleries and shops open their doors for the monthly art walk, free to all comers. Stroll Main Street in the cool of the evening, meet the makers, and see what the Verde Valley's artists have been dreaming up. A gentle Fredas outing, best taken slowly.

  — **Sedona Plein Air Festival begins** — October 16–24, Sedona Arts Center and locations throughout Sedona and the Verde Valley. Painters from across the country set up their easels under the red rocks for nine days of open-air art, free demonstrations, paint-outs, and sales. Watch a landscape become a painting in a single morning's light. Art lovers, this is your harvest festival.

- **Sat, Oct. 17**

  — **Third Annual Autumn Bazaar** — 9 AM–2 PM, White Mountain United Methodist Church, 261 N 5th St, Show Low. Shop, eat, and enjoy: local makers fill the hall with handmade autumn crafts, a bake sale, and special activities for the kids. Proceeds support local vendors and the church's projects, including its food pantry. A beautiful way to spend a fall Loredas in the White Mountains.

  — **Cowboy Prom for a Cause** — gates 5 PM, music 5:30–8:30 PM, Porter Mountain Stables, 3092 Jacks Rd, Pinetop-Lakeside. Heber Ridge headlines a night of live music, dancing, BBQ, and raffle and auction prizes — all to benefit the Johnson family as Tucker and Jenny fight a stage-three cancer diagnosis while raising their two little ones. Admission is $35 a person or $65 a couple. Dust off your best boots and show how strong this community stands.

- **Sun, Oct. 18**

  — **Sedona Community Farmers Market** — 8 AM–noon, 2201 W SR 89A, Sedona. Local growers and makers spread their tables under the red rocks for the Sunday market. Expect farm produce, baked goods, and handmade wares, with the morning light doing its famous work on the cliffs. Arrive early for the best pick of the harvest.

- **Tue, Oct. 20**
  — **Trail Day Volunteer Build in Pine** — from 7 AM, along Hwy 87 in Pine. Don't just use the trail — help build it. PINE Strawberry Fuel Reduction calls hikers, bikers, runners, and neighbors to clear brush, move rocks, and shape trails that will serve the Hold for years, while opening better access routes for firefighters. Tools are provided; bring water, gloves, and your good will. Email trails@psfuelreduction.org to volunteer.

Quests of the Hearth

Quests awaiting:

- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue since Sept. 26 — draw the sconces and ready them before a single torch can burn.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Overdue since Oct. 3 — the printers stand ready; give them their orders.
- ☐ **Finish & install the torches** — Overdue since Oct. 10 — hang the finished torches and light the way.
- ☐ **Build the Mogollon's Hearth shield** — Due Saturday, Oct. 17 — the Hearth's arms take shape; mount it by the front door after.

The torches still wait overdue, and the shield is due Saturday, Oct. 17 — the Hearth's doorway wants its guardians hung and lit.



Torch sconces on the bench and the shield in the carving — the doorway guardians take shape.

Merchant of the Hold

Udderly Divine · *Camp Verde*



The towering cinnamon roll — the Hold's own sweet roll, served in a hall built for dancing.

In Camp Verde's 1915 Historic Dance Hall on Main Street, this family-owned bakery and coffee shop serves breakfast, lunch, homemade baked goods, take-and-bake meals, and a 15-flavor ice-cream parlor besides. The signature wonder is the towering cinnamon roll — the closest thing in any Hold to a true Skyrim sweet roll, kept lofty, one suspects, by a minor levitation charm in the oven. Hearty biscuits and gravy and Theresa's legendary bread pudding round out the feast.

> *"Everything is delicious!"* — Facebook review

545 S Main St, Camp Verde · Mon–Sat 8 AM–2 PM, closed Sundays · (928) 607-0967 · $ (inexpensive) · Good to know: the hall closes at 2 PM sharp — come for breakfast or an early lunch, and note the poodle-friendly patio. · their scrying-mirror page (other travelers call it a 'website')

Why the Hearth sends you:
Because no traveler should pass Camp Verde without tasting a cinnamon roll tall enough to need its own saga — warm, sweet, and gone too soon.

Tales from the Treeline

The Great Leaf-Pile Leap



Jethro leaps, Earl vanishes to the antlers, and Henny emerges crowned.

Middas dawned sunny and clear, and Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) declared the fallen leaves in the Hearth clearing wasted lying flat. By mid-morning he had raked them into a pile taller than Gus's pie rack, and announced the first Great Leaf-Pile Leap, with himself as first leaper and only judge.

Earl (an elk) declined to leap. Earl agreed, with great dignity, to stand nearby and look official. This was a mistake. Jethro's leap scattered half the pile straight over him, and for a long minute the clearing held nothing of Earl but two enormous antlers rising out of the leaves like a sunken ship's masts.

Henny (the Hearth's chicken) marched out of the pile wearing a crown of oak leaves she had not been wearing when she went in, and refused to explain it. Mabel (a wood elf) sighed, fetched Earl a path out with her rake, and ruled the contest a tie.

Jethro is already raking tomorrow's pile. Earl is standing much farther away.

Printed with pride in Payson, in the shadow of the Rim · Set in hot metal by Dude, Bard of the Morning Scroll · May your Middas be free of sabre cats, Clay.

Ask the Hearth ✉

…or write to us straight: mogollonshearth@gmail.com